FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17022

Issue Title : Increased Bearing Interference Fit - Messier-Bugatti-Dowty Wheels

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3245-11	-7, -8

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/11/2017	05/11/2017	04/24/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes using Messier-Bugatti-Dowty (MBD) main gear wheels.

Note: Not applicable for -9 as it does not utilize subject wheel.

Description

Several 737NG operators have reported inboard wheel bearing failures on MBD main gear wheels. While root cause analysis for wheel bearing failures is always difficult, Boeing and MBD suspect that some of the bearing failures may be due to the inboard bearing cup coming loose in the wheel.

In response to this issue, MBD has developed an improved wheel half and modification instructions to address loose bearing cups.

NOTE: There have been no reports of outboard bearing failures on MBD 737 wheels.

Background

Wheel bearing failures occur from time-to-time on all wheels and for a variety of reasons. One of the possible causes for bearing failure is if the bearing cup starts to work loose in the wheel. Once the cup starts to become loose, it can rotate or spin in the wheel, eventually resulting in bearing failure.

Boeing and MBD have examined several wheels that have had inboard bearing failures and there is suspicion that the bearing cups had been loose and spinning in the inboard wheel half.

To address this issue, MBD has elected to increase the interference fit of the inboard bearing cup.

Status

Closed.

Interim Action

See Operator Action section below.

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Final Action

All new MBD wheels with serial numbers 6000C20626 and on will be delivered with an increased interference fit on the inboard bearing (about 15% higher). The wheel part number will remain the same, but wheels will have "Amendment A" stamped after the part number. The referenced MBD service letter introduces the "Amendment A" wheel.

Amendment "A" wheels started being delivered from MBD in mid-2013 and the first new airplane equipped with Amendment "A" wheels is line number 4635 (which delivered in October 2013).

MBD has released a service bulletin to provide instructions on how to rework an earlier (pre-Amendment A) wheel to include increased inboard bearing fit. See the referenced MBD service bulletin, which was released in April 2014.

Operator Action

Operators and their MR&O's are encouraged to check all wheels for loose bearing cups during tire change and at wheel overhaul using all three of the following methods:

1) Visually check the bearing cups for signs of looseness or rotation.

2) Check to see that the bearing cup is fully seated in the wheel. A 0.002 inch (0.05 mm) feeler gage can be used to ensure that there is no gap between the back face of the bearing cup and the register in the wheel half.

3) Try to move or rotate the bearing cup by hand. This check is more useful if the wheel is warm, such as if the check is performed right after the wheel has been removed from a hot water washing machine. A suggested wheel temperature for this check is 150 F (65C).

Any signs of movement by any of the above methods warrants removal of the bearing cup for further investigation.

Also, based on past service experience with this issue, operators may elect to develop a campaign to modify all pre-Amendment A wheels to include the increased bearing fit.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Letter (SL)	Messier-Bugatti-Dowty S/L C20626-32-006		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	Messier-Bugatti-Dowty 32-49-83		
Service Bulletin (SB)	C20626-32-005 (Messier-Bugatti-Dowty)		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Wheel, Main Landing Gear	S277A016-551	Messier-Bugatti-Dowty	C20626200

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Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- In Service Occurrences : null

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